> Emperor settled at Acre and messengers came and went between him and al-Malik al-Kamil until the end of the year.[8]

Frederick refused to leave, and al-Kamil had no wish to start a war. Finally, the two men negotiated the surrender of Jerusalem. The city was a waste; its walls had been razed by al-Mu'azzam during the Syrian revolt, and most of the population had fled. It had no garrison, only a scattering of soldiers, a few officials who would rather have been elsewhere, and a handful of die-hard families. Al-Kamil handed it over to Frederick with a slew of conditions: he was not to rebuild the walls, the nearby villages would remain Muslim, the Temple Mount (including the Dome of the Rock) was to stay in Muslim hands, with the Christians only given visiting rights, and Muslim worship was to continue there uninterrupted.[9]

Without striking a blow, Frederick had attained the goal of all of the Crusades since 1100, and he had done so as an unrepentant excommunicate. It was hard for Rome to rejoice in this. In fact, no one was pleased with the treaty. "This year," lamented the Arab historian Ibn al-Athir, "the Franks (God curse them) took over Jerusalem by treaty. May God restore it to Islam quickly!" "The news spread swiftly throughout the Muslim world," writes Ibn Wasil, "which lamented the loss of Jerusalem, and disapproved strongly of . . . al-Kamil's action as a most dishonorable deed." The Christian reaction was almost as strong; Frederick II had entered into a binding and sacred agreement with an infidel, and this was no way for a Christian emperor to act. (Gregory IX, who had a talent for one-liners, snapped that a covenant had been arranged "between Christ and Belial.")[10]

Ignoring the outcry, Frederick journeyed south to his new possession and entered Jerusalem on March 18 of 1229. Since he was still excommunicated, the patriarch of Jerusalem tried to forbid him to enter the Church of the Holy Sepulchre; but Frederick brushed him aside. "We reverently visited the Tomb of the Living God, like a Catholic Emperor," he wrote in his own dispatches. "On the next day, Sunday, we wore the Crown there, to the honour of the Most Highest." He merely meant that he had entered the church as Holy Roman Emperor, but the indignant patriarch accused him of usurping his infant son's title and crowning himself king of Jerusalem with his own unholy hands, and the rumor spread.

Frederick had never intended to stay in Jerusalem permanently; he appointed two Syrians of Frankish descent, Balian of Sidon and Garnier l'Aleman, as regents in Jerusalem and went back to Acre. On May 1, he headed down towards the harbor, ready to board his ship and set off for home. He had regained the Holy City for Christendom, but he didn't get a hero's